

Question:

A 17-year-old teenager is brought to the emergency department with severe bleeding from his right hand. He was involved in a gang fight about 30 minutes ago where he received a penetrating stab wound by a sharp knife in the region of the ‘anatomical snuffbox’. A vascular surgeon is called in for consultation. Damage to which artery is most likely responsible for his excessive bleeding?

Answer Choices:

- A. Radial artery
- B. Ulnar artery
- C. Princeps pollicis artery
- D. Brachial artery

Reasoning + Answer:

<thought >

To determine which artery was damaged , let's consider the anatomical snuff box . The anatomical snuff box is the name given to the area on the radial side of the palm of the hand that is located between the thumb and index finger and is responsible for the movement of the thumb . This area includes important structures like the ulnar collateral ligament and the flexor pollicis longus tendon .

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< answer >

B . Ulnar artery

</answer >

Thickened at the level of the anatomical snuff box , the ulnar artery is a primary site for bleeding in this scenario . Damage to the ulnar artery would lead to excessive bleeding from the hand , especially in cases like a stab wound .

